

# Jin Cheng

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## EDUCATION

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| <b>Doctoral candidate in Computer Science, ETH Zürich, Switzerland</b>                                  | since 10/2023     |
| <i>Advisor: Prof. Dr. Stelian Coros (ETH Zürich), Prof. Dr. Guanya Shi (Carnegie Mellon University)</i> |                   |
| <b>M.Sc. in Mechanical Engineering, ETH Zürich, Switzerland</b>                                         | 09/2020 – 07/2023 |
| <b>B.E. in Vehicle Engineering, Tsinghua University, China</b>                                          | 09/2016 – 07/2020 |

## EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Scientific Assistant, ETH Zürich</b>                                                                  | since 10/2023     |
| <i>Computational Robotics Lab (CRL), supervised by Prof. Dr. Stelian Coros</i>                           |                   |
| <b>Research Intern, Max Planck Institute for Intelligent Systems</b>                                     | 04/2023 - 09/2023 |
| <i>Autonomous Learning Group, supervised by Prof. Dr. Georg Martius</i>                                  |                   |
| <b>Research Assistant, ETH Zürich</b>                                                                    | 11/2022 - 03/2023 |
| <i>Computational Robotics Lab (CRL), supervised by Prof. Dr. Stelian Coros</i>                           |                   |
| <b>Semester and Master Thesis, ETH Zürich</b>                                                            | 09/2021 - 11/2022 |
| <i>Robotic Systems Lab (RSL), supervised by Prof. Dr. Marco Hutter</i>                                   |                   |
| <b>Research Assistant and Bachelor Thesis, Tsinghua University</b>                                       | 09/2019 - 05/2020 |
| <i>State Key Laboratory of Intelligent Green Vehicle and Mobility, supervised by Prof. Dr. Qing Zhou</i> |                   |

## PUBLICATIONS

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| <b>Teaching Robots Like Dogs:</b>                                                                                                                                             |         |
| <b>Learning Agile Navigation from Luring, Gesture, and Speech (CoRL 2026)</b>                                                                                                 |         |
| <i>Taerim Yoon, Dongho Kang, Jin Cheng, Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Yijiang Huang, Minsung Ahn, Stelian Coros, Sungjoon Choi</i>                                                     | 01/2026 |
| <b>TARC: Time-Adaptive Robotic Control (CoRL 2026)</b>                                                                                                                        |         |
| <i>Arnav Sukhija, Lenart Treven, Jin Cheng, Florian Dörfler, Stelian Coros, Andreas Krause</i>                                                                                | 09/2025 |
| <b>APEX: Action Priors Enable Efficient Exploration for Robust Motion Tracking on Legged Robots (IROS 2026)</b>                                                               |         |
| <i>Shivam Sood, Laukik Nakhwa, Ge Sun, Yuhong Cao, Jin Cheng, Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Taerim Yoon, Sungjoon Choi, Stelian Coros, Guillaume Sartoretti</i>                        | 06/2026 |
| <b>Maximum Entropy Behavior Exploration for Sim2Real Zero-Shot Reinforcement Learning (RLC 2026)</b>                                                                          |         |
| <i>Jiajun Hu, Núria Armengol Urpí, Jin Cheng, Stelian Coros</i>                                                                                                               | 05/2026 |
| <b>CAIMAN: Causal Action Influence Detection for Sample-Efficient Loco-Manipulation (ICRA 2026)</b>                                                                           |         |
| <i>Yuanchen Yuan, Jin Cheng, Núria Armengol Urpí, Stelian Coros</i>                                                                                                           | 02/2026 |
| <b>Benchmarking Whole-Body Motion Tracking Policies via Just Dance:</b>                                                                                                       |         |
| <b>Using a Commercial Console Game for Embodied-AI Evaluation (CVPR Findings 2026)</b>                                                                                        |         |
| <i>Jeonghwan Kim, Wontaek Kim, Yidan Lu, Jin Cheng, Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Zicheng Zeng, Zekun Qi, Zhiyang Dou, Nitish Sontakke, Donghoon Baek, Li Yi, Sehoon Ha, Tianyu Li</i> | 02/2026 |
| <b>Whole-Body Inverse Dynamics MPC for Legged Loco-Manipulation (RA-L)</b>                                                                                                    |         |
| <i>Lukas Molnar, Jin Cheng, Gabriele Fadini, Dongho kang, Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Stelian Coros</i>                                                                              | 11/2025 |
| <b>RAMBO: RL-Augmented Model-Based Whole-Body Control for Loco-Manipulation (RA-L)</b>                                                                                        |         |
| <i>Jin Cheng, Dongho Kang, Gabriele Fadini, Guanya Shi, Stelian Coros</i>                                                                                                     | 07/2025 |

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| <b>Spatio-Temporal Motion Retargeting for Quadruped Robots (T-RO)</b><br><i>Taerim Yoon, Dongho Kang, Seungmin Kim, Jin Cheng, Minsung Ahn, Stelian Coros, Sungjoon Choi</i>                                                                                  | 07/2025 |
| <b>SATA: Safe and Adaptive Torque-Based Locomotion Policies Inspired by Animal Learning (RSS 2025)</b><br><i>Peizhuo Li, Hongyi Li, Ge Sun, Jin Cheng, Xinrong Yang, Guillaume Bellegarda, Milad Shafiee, Yuhong Cao, Auke Ijspeert, Guillaume Sartoretti</i> | 02/2025 |
| <b>DARE: Diffusion Policy for Autonomous Robot Exploration (ICRA 2025)</b><br><i>Yuhong Cao, Jeric Lew, Jingsong Liang, Jin Cheng, Guillaume Sartoretti</i>                                                                                                   | 02/2025 |
| <b>RobotKeyframing: Learning Locomotion with High-Level Objectives via Mixture of Dense and Sparse Rewards (CoRL 2024)</b><br><i>Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Jin Cheng, Dongho Kang, Robert Sumner, and Stelian Coros</i>                                            | 09/2024 |
| <b>Offline Diversity Maximization Under Imitation Constraints (RLC 2024)</b><br><i>Marin Vlastelica, Jin Cheng, Georg Martius, Pavel Kolev</i>                                                                                                                | 05/2024 |
| <b>Learning Diverse Skills for Local Navigation under Multi-constraint Optimality (ICRA 2024)</b><br><i>Jin Cheng, Marin Vlastelica, Pavel Kolev, Chenhao Li, Georg Martius</i>                                                                               | 02/2024 |
| <b>RL + Model-based Control: Using On-demand Optimal Control to Learn Versatile Legged Locomotion (RA-L)</b><br><i>Dongho Kang, Jin Cheng, Miguel Zamora, Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Stelian Coros</i>                                                              | 09/2023 |
| <b>Haptic Teleoperation of High-dimensional Robotic Systems Using a Feedback MPC Framework (IROS 2022)</b><br><i>Jin Cheng, Firas Abi-Farraj, Farbod Farshidian, Marco Hutter</i>                                                                             | 10/2022 |

## PREPRINTS

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| <b>Learning Steerable Imitation Controllers from Unstructured Animal Motions (arXiv)</b><br><i>Dongho Kang, Jin Cheng, Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Taerim Yoon, Sungjoon Choi, Stelian Coros</i>                               | 07/2025 |
| <b>Learning More With Less: Sample Efficient Dynamics Learning and Model-Based RL for Loco-Manipulation (arXiv)</b><br><i>Benjamin Hoffman, Jin Cheng, Chenhao Li, Stelian Coros</i>                                    | 02/2025 |
| <b>MetaLoco: Universal Quadrupedal Locomotion with Meta-Reinforcement Learning and Motion Imitation (arXiv)</b><br><i>Fatemeh Zargarbashi, Fabrizio Di Giuro, Jin Cheng, Dongho Kang, Bhavya Sukhija, Stelian Coros</i> | 09/2024 |

## INVITED TALKS

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <b>Intelligent Motion Lab (IMO) @ Seoul National University (SNU)</b>               | 10/2025 |
| <b>Frontier AI &amp; Robotics (FAR) @ Amazon</b>                                    | 05/2025 |
| <b>Robotics and AI Institute (RAI) @ Zurich</b>                                     | 04/2025 |
| <b>Biomimetic Robotics Laboratory @ Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT)</b> | 11/2023 |

## TEACHING

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| <b>Computational Models of Motion (263-5807-00)</b><br><i>Computational Robotics Lab (CRL) at ETH Zürich, lectured by S. Coros</i>                    | 02/2026 - 07/2026 |
| <b>Probabilistic Artificial Intelligence (263-5210-00)</b><br><i>Learning &amp; Adaptive Systems Group (LAS) at ETH Zürich, lectured by A. Krause</i> | 08/2025 - 02/2026 |
| <b>Computational Models of Motion (263-5807-00)</b><br><i>Computational Robotics Lab (CRL) at ETH Zürich, lectured by S. Coros</i>                    | 02/2025 - 07/2025 |
| <b>Probabilistic Artificial Intelligence (263-5210-00)</b><br><i>Learning &amp; Adaptive Systems Group (LAS) at ETH Zürich, lectured by A. Krause</i> | 08/2024 - 02/2025 |

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| <b>Introduction to Machine Learning (252-0220-00)</b><br><i>Learning &amp; Adaptive Systems Group (LAS) at ETH Zürich, lectured by F. Perez Cruz, F. Yang</i>  | 02/2024 - 08/2024 |
| <b>Dynamic Programming and Optimal Control (151-0563-01)</b><br><i>Institute for Dynamic Systems and Control (IDSC) at ETH Zürich, lectured by R. D'Andrea</i> | 08/2022 - 02/2023 |
| <b>Recursive Estimation (151-0566-00)</b><br><i>Institute for Dynamic Systems and Control (IDSC) at ETH Zürich, lectured by R. D'Andrea</i>                    | 02/2022 - 08/2022 |
| <b>Dynamic Programming and Optimal Control (151-0563-01)</b><br><i>Institute for Dynamic Systems and Control (IDSC) at ETH Zürich, lectured by R. D'Andrea</i> | 08/2021 - 02/2022 |

## SKILLS AND SERVICES

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**Language:** Chinese (Native), English (C1), German (B2)  
**Journal Reviewer:** T-RO, RA-L  
**Conference Reviewer:** CoRL, RSS, ICRA, IROS, NeurIPS, RLC, SIGGRAPH

## SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

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| <b>Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award</b><br><i>ETH Zürich</i>                          | 03/2022<br><i>Zürich, Switzerland</i>     |
| <b>Friends of Tsinghua Scholarship – German Scholarship</b><br><i>Tsinghua University</i> | 10/2019<br><i>Beijing, China</i>          |
| <b>Academic Excellence Scholarship</b><br><i>Tsinghua University</i>                      | 10/2018, 10/2019<br><i>Beijing, China</i> |
| <b>Volunteer Public Service Scholarship</b><br><i>Tsinghua University</i>                 | 10/2018<br><i>Beijing, China</i>          |
| <b>Integrated Excellence Scholarship</b><br><i>Tsinghua University</i>                    | 10/2017<br><i>Beijing, China</i>          |

04.09.2026